

Alexey Zarakovskiy

Senior Software Engineer; Java/JVM, Go, full-stack

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/stack

LANGUAGES & FRAMEWORKS

Java Spring Boot Kotlin Golang Python TypeScript JS CSS Node.js React PHP

APIS, INTEGRATION & MESSAGING

Distributed Systems REST JWT gRPC Protobuf GraphQL Kafka SQS/SNS OpenAI API MCP

CLOUD, DATA & INFRASTRUCTURE AS CODE

AWS GCP AWS CDK Helm Terraform PostgreSQL DynamoDB Redis Elasticsearch

PLATFORM ENGINEERING & OPERATIONS

Kubernetes CRDs RBAC Docker GitHub Actions ArgoCD Prometheus Grafana Datadog

/experience

Toptal

Remote

Apr 2026 - Present

Freelance Full-stack Engineer

Java

Golang

TS/React

Sabbatical

Focus on family, personal projects & AI engineering

Jan 2026 - Apr 2026

Personio

Amsterdam

Mar 2023 - Dec 2025

Intelligent HR platform serving 12k+ customers

Senior Software Engineer

3 yrs 4 mos

Whistleblowing project

Golang

TS/React

Co-architected and launched a greenfield EU-compliant whistleblowing service from product and regulatory requirements. Designed dual-AWS infrastructure and anonymous authentication for full anonymity and regulatory isolation. The launch generated approximately €1M ARR soon after release.

Kickstarted the Go service and AWS CDK infrastructure. Coached engineers in Go, guided organizational adoption of the Go stack, led a maintenance team of 3 engineers, and remained the service's primary technical owner post-launch.

Shipped features end-to-end: Go backend, TypeScript/React frontend, and AWS infrastructure.

Delivered 99.92% uptime with p99 <200ms latency, resolved 14 critical security vulnerabilities, and established automated testing with Docker Testcontainers and Datadog synthetic monitoring.

Surveys project

Kotlin/Spring

TS/React

Led major platform features including a dashboard revamp, question result categorization, and date-driven dynamic filters. Built a user-data snapshot tool that prevents exponential database growth.

Owned the zero-downtime migration of a 24GB dataset after identifying the snapshot issue. Reduced P99 latency from 600ms to <300ms across 14 endpoints through PostgreSQL index and schema optimization.

Shipped features end-to-end: Kotlin/Spring backend with TypeScript/React frontend.

Kotlin · Spring · Golang · TS · React · k8s · AWS · Helm · Postgres · Kafka · SQS · gRPC · Protobuf

BEAT | FREENOW

Amsterdam

Sep 2019 - Jan 2023

Ride-hailing platform with 250k+ drivers

Senior Backend Engineer

3 yrs 4 mos

Pricing service

Golang

Led the extraction of the core pricing engine from the monolith into Go microservices and introduced dynamic incentive-driven pricing based on hexagonal geo-zones to balance driver supply and demand across markets.

API Gateway & Authentication service Golang

- Helped form a four-engineer team that extracted routing and authentication from the monolith. Built a dynamic Go API gateway handling **10k+ RPS** and a high-throughput, DynamoDB-backed authentication service.
- Ran the legacy and replacement routing and authentication paths side-by-side, completed the live migration, and removed the corresponding monolith functionality.
- Decentralized routing and authorization with custom Kubernetes CRDs, Helm-based automatic service discovery and route registration, and a Go authorization library adopted by all **7** cross-functional teams.
- Contributed CRD-based routing support to the open-source Skipper framework through **PR #2048**.
- Added a Redis idempotency guard for one-time JWT signup tokens and built containerized integration tests for routing and authentication during the migration.

Golang · Kubernetes · AWS · DynamoDB · Redis · Docker · Kafka · PHP · gRPC · Protobuf · OSS

fashionTrade Amsterdam

May 2018 - Jul 2019

Early-stage B2B fashion marketplace startup

Senior Java Engineer 1 yr 3 mos

Data integration service Java TS/React

- Took a leading engineering role in a small team building a Java-based customer data pipeline for hundreds of wholesale fashion customers.
- Built asynchronous ingestion and entity-matching flows with Java, Kafka, and Elasticsearch, including race-condition handling across the pipeline.
- Integrated external retailer data with internal master entities to enrich the platform for both shops and wholesale customers.

Java · Python · REST · Docker · Kafka · GCP · Kubernetes · Elasticsearch · Typescript · React

SDL Web Amsterdam

Oct 2015 - Apr 2018

Open-source adapter framework for an enterprise CMS

Senior Java Engineer 1 yr 8 mos **Team Lead** 11 mos

Developer Experience Accelerator framework Java

- Led DXA, the Java/Spring counterpart of an open-source framework that helped customer applications integrate with a proprietary enterprise CMS.
- Implemented reflection-based dynamic model mapping to reduce the effort required for third-party integrations.
- Reviewed and integrated community contributions to the open-source project.

Java · Groovy · Spring · Maven · Gradle · OSS · PowerShell · C#.NET

Earlier roles Poland & Russia

EPAM Systems - Consultancy (PayPal) · (Senior) Full-stack Engineer	3 yrs	Java	JS/Angular	2012-2015
L.I.C. - Workflows automation · Full-stack Engineer	1 yr 1 mo	Java	JS/jQuery	2011-2012
Orange - Web studio · Full-stack Engineer / Co-founder	2 yrs 1 mo	PHP	JS/jQuery	2009-2011
State factory - Real-time monitoring · Engineer	3 yrs	C#	C++	2006-2009

/education

ITMO University Russia

2005-2011

Bachelor & Master in Computer Science